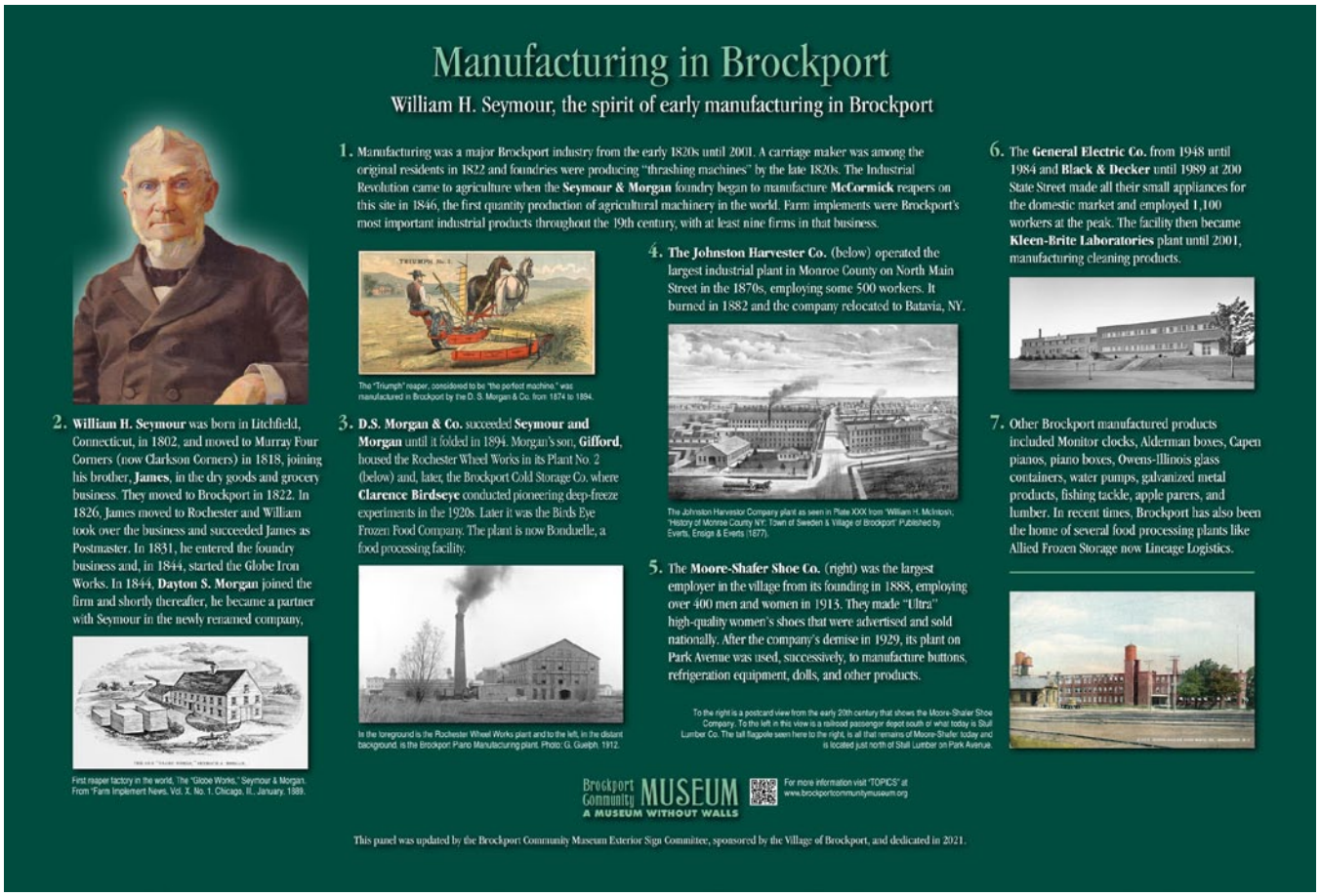

Fig. 1. This is the fourteenth panel placed by the Brockport Community Museum created as a replacement for one already existing at this site as seen on the next page. The replacement panel was funded by the Village of Brockport, and installed in 2021.

Fig. 2. The panel is located on the south bank of the canal, just east of the Welcome Center.

Fig. 3. You are looking west. The building to the left in the frame is the Welcome Center.

Interpretive Panels Project

Fig. 4. The "Manufacturing in Brockport," and the "Brockport and the Canal" replacement panels, were announced during this August 12, 2021 Summer Serenades concert held near the Welcome Center on the south bank of the canal. In this view you are looking to the northeast. The featured group. "Feedback." was sponsored by the Brockport Community Museum through a generous donation of a board member.

Fig. 5. (l-r): Museum board member Archie Kutz presents the panels as Summer Serenades Master of Ceremonies Gary Skoog looks on.

THE VILLAGE OF BROCKPORT
PRESENTS
SUMMER SERENADES
2021
FREE – FAMILY FRIENDLY
BROCKPORT WELCOME CENTER
THURSDAYS – 11 Water Street

Alcohol & tobacco not permitted at concerts
Information: 585-637-5300 ext. 110
www.brockportny.org

In case of rain, music will be at St. Luke's Episcopal Church - Main and State Streets

July – 7:00 p.m.

15 Zak's Pack
Blues, Rhythm, and Rock n' Roll

22 8 Days a Week
Our Favorite Beatles Revival Group

29 Finger Lakes Opera
Singing Broadway and Opera Favorites

August – 6:30 p.m.

5 Rochester Philharmonic Orchestra
The Full RPO - **7:30pm indoors at the SUNY Brockport SERC** (map is at www.brockport.edu)
Sponsored by the James M. and Olive Edmunds Memorial Fund at Rochester Area Community Foundation and by the Killian J. and Caroline F. Schmitt Foundation and by the New York State Canal Corporation

12 Feedback
High Energy Classic Rock, Motown, Blues and Country; vocals by Vernette Hill
Sponsored by the Brockport Community Museum

19 Chris Wilson
Internationally known songwriter, vocalist, guitar and ukulele artist
Sponsored by the Bixler family in memory of Jennifer Schlecht and Amy Schlecht Tedla

26 Rochester Metropolitan Jazz Orchestra
Traditional and Contemporary Big Band Jazz
Sponsored by Richard and Joan Fenton

Thanks to our other generous community sponsors:
GEORGE & CAROL BOTT, TERRY & FRED CARBONE, JACQUIE DAVIS, ROGER EIBL, ERIE CANALWAY HERITAGE FUND, INC., H. LARRY & DOROTHY HUMM, PATTY & ARCHIE KUTZ, BRUCE LESLIE, THE PYLYSHENKO FAMILY, SARA'S GARDEN & NURSERY, SUNY BROCKPORT, WESTSIDE NEWS INC.

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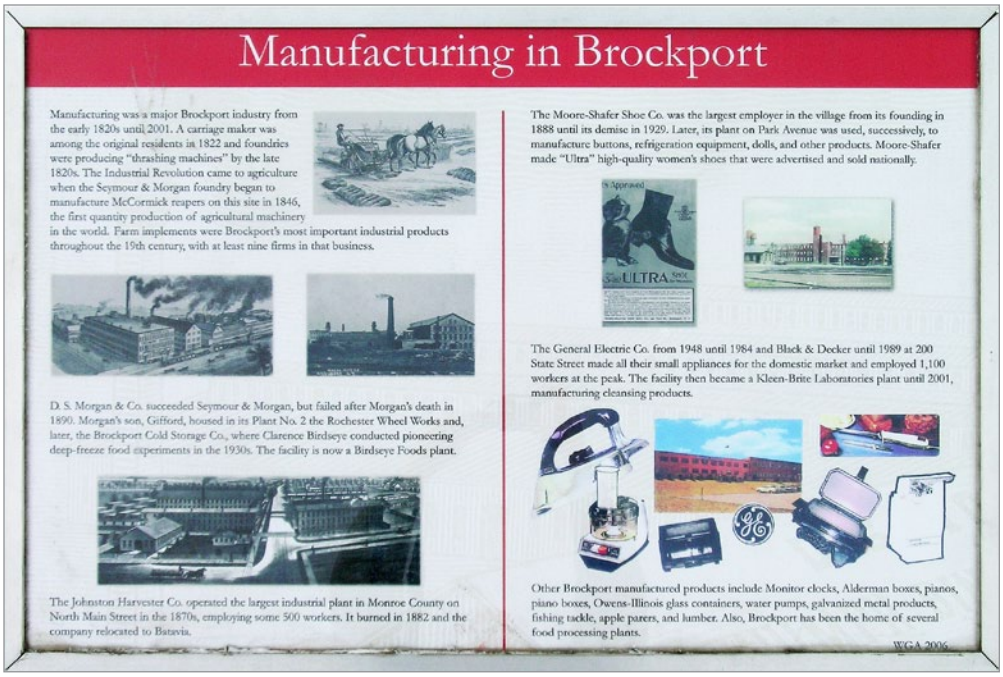
Fig. 6. The 2021 Summer Serenades concert series calendar.



Manufacturing in Brockport

Manufacturing was a major Brockport industry from the early 1820s until 2001. A carriage maker was among the original residents in 1822 and foundries were producing "thrashing machines" by the late 1820s. The Industrial Revolution came to agriculture when the Seymour & Morgan foundry began to manufacture McCormick reapers on this site in 1846, the first quantity production of agricultural machinery in the world. Farm implements were Brockport's most important industrial products throughout the 19th century, with at least nine firms in that business.

D. S. Morgan & Co. succeeded Seymour & Morgan, but failed after Morgan's death in 1890. Morgan's son, Gifford, housed in its Plant No. 2 the Rochester Wheel Works and, later, the Brockport Cold Storage Co., where Clarence Birdseye conducted pioneering deep-freeze food experiments in the 1930s. The facility is now a Birdseye Foods plant.

The Johnston Harvester Co. operated the largest industrial plant in Monroe County on North Main Street in the 1870s, employing some 500 workers. It burned in 1882 and the company relocated to Batavia.

The Moore-Shafer Shoe Co. was the largest employer in the village from its founding in 1888 until its demise in 1929. Later, its plant on Park Avenue was used, successively, to manufacture buttons, refrigeration equipment, dolls, and other products. Moore-Shafer made "Ultra" high-quality women's shoes that were advertised and sold nationally.

The General Electric Co. from 1948 until 1984 and Black & Decker until 1989 at 200 State Street made all their small appliances for the domestic market and employed 1,100 workers at the peak. The facility then became a Kleen-Brite Laboratories plant until 2001, manufacturing cleansing products.

Other Brockport manufactured products include Monitor clocks, Alderman boxes, pianos, piano boxes, Owens-Illinois glass containers, water pumps, galvanized metal products, fishing tackle, apple parers, and lumber. Also, Brockport has been the home of several food processing plants.

WGA 2006

Fig. 7. This is the original "Manufacturing in Brockport" panel, created by William G. Andrews. It was funded by a Village canal bank improvement grant, and installed in 2006. This photo was taken in 2009. It, and the original "Brockport and the Canal" panel (installed in 2000), were the forerunners that served as inspiration for the many interpretive panels created by the Brockport Community Museum since then.

Related focus documents on our website about:

William H. Seymour: Under TOPICS > People > Historic.

Businesses: Under TOPICS > Businesses.

A C K N O W L E D G E M E N T S

Exterior sign committee:

Allan Berry, Chair
William G. Andrews
Rozenn Bailleul-LeSuer
Jim Fallon
Norman Frisch
Archie Kutz
Bruce Leslie
Robb Westbrook

Figure credits:

Fig. 1. Panel designed by Norm Frisch
Fig. 2. Map version 2021.07.24 by Norm Frisch
Fig. 3. 2021.09.17 photo by Garrett Roe
Fig. 4. 2021.08.12 photo by Rozenn Bailleul-LeSuer
Fig. 5. 2021.08.12 photo by Lori Skoog
Fig. 6. Scan of 5.5 x 17" promotional flier
Fig. 7. Original panel by William G. Andrews,
2009.01.09 photo by Norm Frisch